



END USER GUIDE

pktFlow User Guide

A complete guide for analysts and everyday users of the pktFlow network flow analytics dashboard.

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1. Platform Overview

pktFlow is a real-time network flow analytics platform. It collects NetFlow telemetry from your organization's routers and switches, stores it efficiently, and presents it through a web dashboard that you access from any browser.

No software installation is needed on your workstation. You interact entirely through the browser. The data you see reflects actual traffic flowing across your network infrastructure.

i pktFlow receives live data from all monitored network segments. Dashboard data is current within seconds of traffic occurring on the network.

2. Logging In

Navigate to the pktFlow URL provided by your administrator. Enter your username and password and click **Sign In**.

1 Enter credentials

Your username and password are provided by your pktFlow administrator.

2 Click Sign In

You are taken directly to the Dashboard. Sessions last approximately 8 hours.

3 Troubleshoot

If login fails, check your username spelling. Passwords are case-sensitive. Contact your admin if locked out.

3. Navigation & Pages

PAGE	DESCRIPTION	WHO CAN ACCESS
	Live traffic overview, charts, top talkers	All roles
Flow Explorer	Searchable flow record table with export	All roles
	Traffic breakdown for a single IP/device	All roles
Topology	Interactive D3 network graph	All roles
	Active and historical rule-triggered events	All roles
Settings	System config, alert rules, notifications	Admin only
	User account management	Admin only

4. The Dashboard

The Dashboard is your home page — a real-time snapshot of network activity across all monitored sites. Key panels include:

- **Traffic Over Time** — bytes and flows per minute. Spot spikes or drops.
- **Top Talkers** — source IPs generating the most traffic.
- **Top Destinations** — most-contacted destination IPs.
- **Protocol Mix** — TCP, UDP, ICMP breakdown by volume.
- **Site Breakdown** — per-site traffic comparison (when multiple collectors are active).
- **Ingest Health** — confirms pktFlow is receiving live data.

5. Flow Explorer

The Flow Explorer provides direct access to individual flow records. Filter by source/destination IP, port, protocol, site, and time range. Results appear in a sortable table.

Column	Meaning
Time	When the flow was received
Src/Dst IP	Source and destination IP addresses
Ports	Source and destination TCP/UDP ports
Bytes / Packets	Volume of data transferred in this flow
Site	Which collector site reported this flow

💡 Click any column header to sort. Click again to reverse. CIDR notation works in IP filters (e.g. 10.0.0.0/8).

6–8. Device View, Topology & Alerts

Device View — Click any IP address link to see all traffic for that device: traffic over time, top peers, bytes in/out, and a full flow table filtered to that IP.

Topology Map — A D3 force-directed graph of device relationships. Pan and zoom with mouse. Drag nodes to reposition. Hover over nodes and edges to see traffic details.

Alerts — Shows events fired by the rule engine: Data Gap, New Host, Rate Spike, Threshold, and Port/Protocol anomalies. States: Active, Resolved, Acknowledged.

9–12. Filtering, Export, Roles & Password

Filtering — All page filters combine with AND logic. Clear individual filters with the ✕ button. The time range picker in the top-right affects all panels on the current page.

Export — Apply your filters in Flow Explorer, then click the Export button. Choose CSV (for spreadsheets) or JSON (for programmatic use). The file contains all matching records.

Roles — Admin (full access), Analyst (read + export + acknowledge alerts), Viewer (read-only). Your role is set by an administrator.

Password — Change your password from the account menu (top-right corner). Enter your current password, then new password twice. Takes effect immediately. If locked out, contact your admin.